

One more game with *Maia*.

What 1.4 million rated games reveal about the way we practice, come back, and take on a familiar chess opponent.

Three Maia bots. Three years of play.
A closer look at the habits behind the moves.



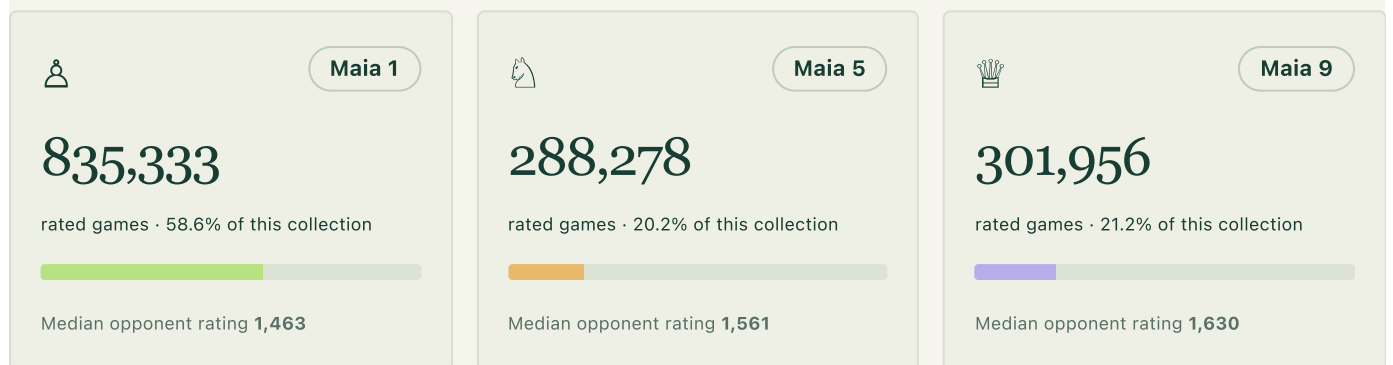
● **The lens:** official Maia 1, 5 and 9 on Lichess. Detailed findings cover collected **rated games only**; opposing accounts are not necessarily distinct people or verified humans.

01 / YOUR FAMILIAR SPARRING PARTNERS

Three Maias. Many ways to practice.

Maia 1 is the busiest of the three: 58.6% of collected rated games were played against it. The higher-numbered bots attract higher-rated opponents, but all three draw a broad range of ratings.

This report looks at how accounts use Maia and whether their later results differ from their early ones. It does not measure move quality or prove that playing Maia causes improvement.



Later results are a little better. But the story is mixed.

Among 1,066 persistent accounts, average score rose from 45.1% in their first 20 games to 48.3% in their last 20 against a matched Maia opponent. That is a modest **3.2-point increase**.

All three Maia's · 1,066 matched accounts



Full bar width = 100% score. Each account counts equally. Change: **+3.2 percentage points**.

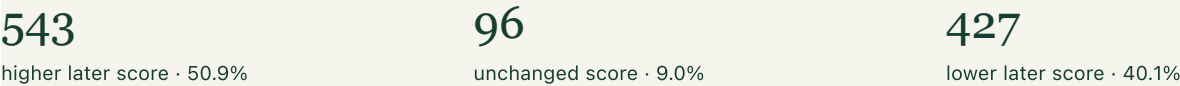
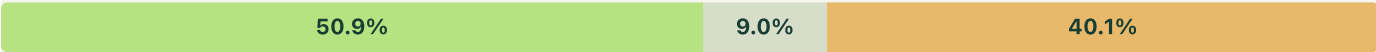
Score means wins plus half a point per draw, divided by games. A 50% score is half the available points, not necessarily a 50% win rate.

How we made the comparison

Same account. Same Maia. Same exact clock and speed category. At least 40 usable games, with at least 30 days between the early and later groups. One qualifying combination per account; each account gets equal weight.

"First" and "last" mean observed in this collection, not their first-ever or final Maia games. These accounts are a small, selected subset of the 93,020 observed accounts.

More accounts scored better, but many scored worse.



The Maia detail matters. The average rise is clearest against Maia 1 (+4.0 points). Against Maia 9 it is only +0.3 points, and turns negative in the stricter comparison. The data do not support a uniform improvement story across all three bots.

Maia	Accounts	First 20 score	Last 20 score	Change
Maia 1	681	43.4%	47.4%	+4.0 pp
Maia 5	176	46.6%	50.0%	+3.4 pp
Maia 9	209	49.3%	49.7%	+0.3 pp

Stricter check: requiring 60 games and a 90-day gap leaves 649 accounts. Their average score rises 2.9 points. This is an overlapping subset, not an independent replication. Twenty-game scores are noisy; "higher" is not a test of statistically reliable individual improvement.

Maia gives opponents a real contest.

Across the full collection, opposing accounts won about four games in ten against each bot. Maia 9's visitors are generally higher rated; similar win rates do not mean the bots are equally strong.

Opponent facing	Win	Draw	Loss	Unclassified
Maia 1	40.3%	6.7%	52.8%	0.2%
Maia 5	43.6%	8.0%	48.2%	0.2%
Maia 9	41.2%	8.2%	50.3%	0.3%

Opponent perspective; denominator is all games against that bot. Blank winners are classified as draws only for explicit draw/stalemate endings. Other no-winner endings remain unclassified. These are recorded outcomes, including 110 cheat terminations in the full dataset.

What a Maia fan can take away: some returning accounts show better later results against a familiar bot, especially Maia 1. People who keep playing are a selected group and can practice elsewhere. This comparison cannot show that Maia caused the gains.

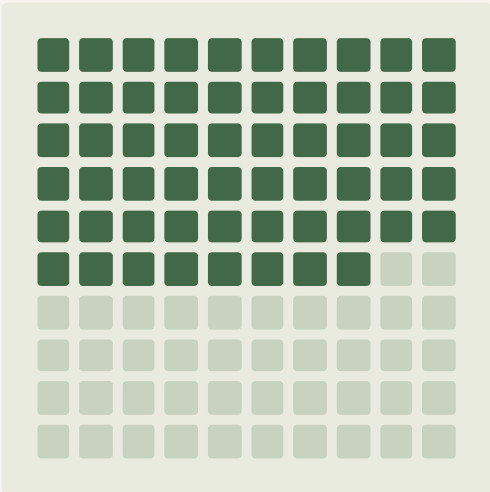
A small core plays a lot of chess.

57.7%

of all collected games came from the busiest 1% of identified opposing accounts.

That is 930 accounts out of 93,020. At the other end, 45.2% appeared in exactly one game. The median was just two.

Activity in this window, not lifetime loyalty. 147 games have no opponent handle; they remain in the total-game denominator.



Each square represents roughly 1% of games.
■ Games played by the busiest 1% of accounts (rounded).

21,193

accounts tried more than one Maia

6,830

accounts tried all three

13,951

games from the busiest account

THE “ONE MORE GAME” PATTERN

A loss is more often followed by a quick return.

For every Maia, a quick return to the same bot was more common after a loss than after a win. Against Maia 1, the rates were 53.5% after losses and 43.2% after wins.

Maia 1

After a win



After a loss



Maia 5

After a win



After a loss



Maia 9

After a win



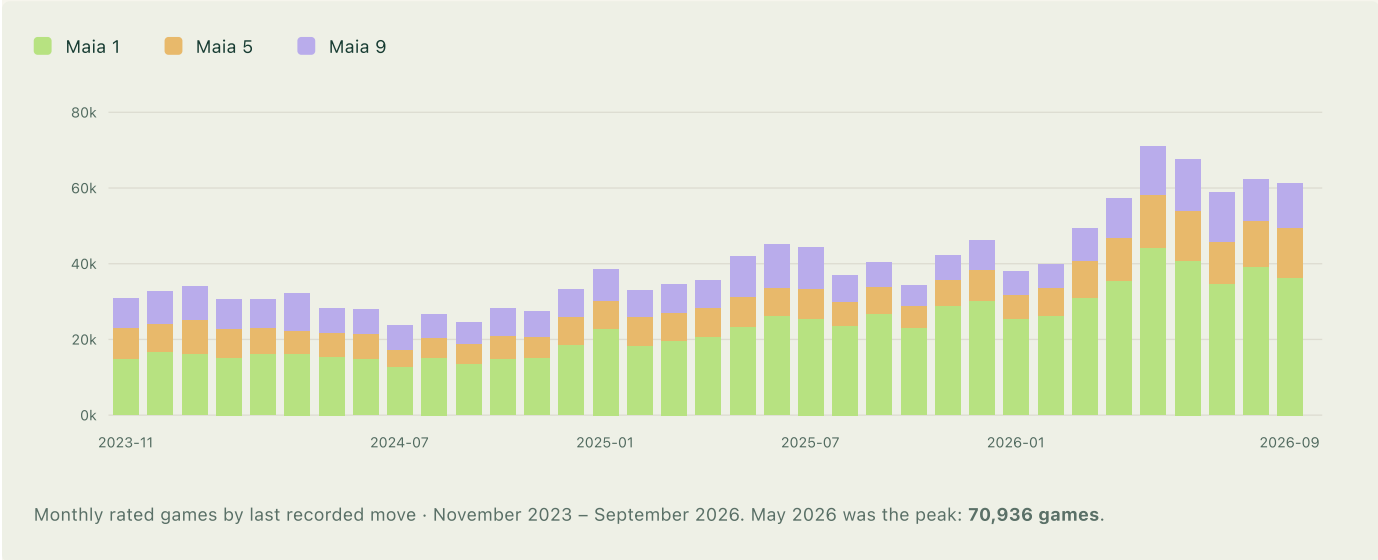
After a loss



Share of eligible games followed by the same account’s next observed Maia rated game against the same bot within 10 minutes of the previous last recorded move. Full bar width = 100%. This does not identify a formal rematch or tell us why the account returned.

Maia's rated play is on the rise.

+79.4% more games in the latest 12 complete months than in the first 12.



Comparison: Nov 2023–Oct 2024 (350,152 games) vs Oct 2025–Sep 2026 (628,041). October 2023 and October 2026 are partial and excluded. This does not establish growth in casual play.

SET THE CLOCK

Ten minutes, no increment.

10+0 is the most common exact time control, accounting for 15.1% of games. But practice takes many forms: no single setting dominates.

10+0	15.1%
214,879 games	
5+3	10.0%
142,986 games	
10+5	6.1%
87,149 games	
3+2	4.8%
67,850 games	
15+10	4.7%
66,378 games	

FAMILIAR TERRITORY

The Sicilian leads the list.

It appears in about one in ten games. These opening families describe positions reached by both players; they are not a list of moves chosen by Maia alone.

Sicilian Defense	9.9%
141,375 games	
Queen's Pawn Game	9.6%
136,511 games	
French Defense	6.0%
84,991 games	
Scandinavian Defense	5.5%
78,670 games	
Caro-Kann Defense	4.6%
64,909 games	

Most Maia play is casual.

58.7%

of summed all-time profile game counts were casual. The rated collection is a detailed window into Maia use, but it leaves out a large part of the story.

6.49 million

estimated distinct all-time games across the three bots, from their profile counters.

Snapshot: 4 Oct 2026, 07:12 UTC. 6,486,805 summed entries minus 21 Maia-vs-Maia overlaps = 6,486,784. Moving counters may not synchronize exactly. Do not add this to the rated dataset.

05 / BEHIND THE NUMBERS

Curiosity, with receipts.

Every chart starts with public game metadata. You can download the records, inspect the definitions, and rebuild the report.

What we have

1,425,567 distinct game IDs from Maia 1, 5 and 9. Games with last recorded moves from 4 Oct 2023 00:00 UTC up to, but excluding, 4 Oct 2026 09:00 UTC. Twelve compressed CSV files contain dates, results, account handles, ratings, clocks and opening labels.

What we don't

No moves, evaluations, move-by-move clocks, or casual-game history. No view of practice elsewhere. We cannot measure blunders, explain why someone returned, or attribute improvement to Maia.

What we checked

File hashes, row counts, unique game IDs and last-recorded-move time bounds. The collector's date splitting was reported as complete; the public files cannot independently prove that the API omitted no games.

[Download the game data ↗](#)

[Practice comparisons · JSON ↗](#)

[Usage analyses · JSON ↗](#)

[Original aggregates · JSON ↗](#)

[Methods & limitations ↗](#)